

Bulwark 1475

Bulwark 1475 is a 1990s style arcade game that blends strategy, puzzle and shoot-'em-up elements. Its core gameplay alternates between *combat* (firing cannons at attacking ships or enemy forts) and *building* (repairing and expanding castle walls with Tetris-like blocks). In game play, a computer opponent fires cannons from their naval fleet and/or from their castle(s) across a river, wall (can't be damaged), or canyon at the players fortress walls. A typical round proceeds as follows:

- **Cannon Placement:** At the start of each round (and after building phases), the player has a set number of cannons based on fully walled castles captured (each enclosed castle gives one cannon, the “home” castle gives two). These cannons are placed inside the player’s castle walls to be used in the upcoming battle. Cannons must fit inside the castle walls to be placed.
- **Combat Phase:** Enemy ships and/or rival forts attack the player’s walls. The player aims each cannon (with a crosshair) and fires at their opponent’s castle walls or ships (moving targets). Cannonballs travel slowly, so the player must “lead” shots to hit ships. The attacker’s goal is to breach the opponent’s walls. (Combat ends when enough ships are sunk, or after a time limit). Battles fault simultaneously.
- **Building Phase:** After combat, any section of wall with gaps is vulnerable. The player is given random wall segments (in various shapes) to place on the map and repair or extend the walls. Pieces cannot overlap existing obstacles; large blocks may not fit small gaps, leaving overhangs that complicate future repairs. Surrounding additional castles with walls in this phase grants more territory and cannons next round. Pieces can be rotated. Player has 20 seconds to repair and build walls.
- **Win/Lose Conditions:** The cycle repeats: players rebuild walls, places cannons, then battles each round. If at the end of the building phase, if **no castle remains fully enclosed by wall**, the game ends. The rounds and levels continue until the enemy has been defeated or the player is not able to rebuild the walls of at least one castle. Game play consists of 5 levels with 3 rounds in each level. Once the game is won, the losing commander’s avatar is dramatically executed by “walking the plank” as a victory scene.
- **Phases are timed; Cannon Placement = 15 seconds, Combat = 25 seconds, and Building = 20 seconds. There is a title screen between each phase to let the play know what’s next.**

Game Play

1. Title screen with Start button.
2. Player selects their home castle, and it is instantly surrounded by walls with enough room for 3 cannons. No building to start the game.

3. Once the home castle is selected a title screen appears that says, “Place Your Cannons”. Title screen is shown for 3 seconds.
4. Player places 3 cannons within the walls of their home castle.
5. Once the last cannon is placed, a title screen appears that says, “Get Ready for Battle!”. Title screen is shown for 3 seconds.
6. Battle begins. Player and computer opponents start firing. Combat is 25 seconds.
7. Once time is up, a title screen appears that says, “Rebuild Your Walls”. Title screen is shown for 3 seconds.
8. Opponents have 20 seconds to fully complete the walls around at least one of their castles and try to build walls around their other castles to lock in as many as possible to increase their firing power.
9. Once time is up, a title screen appears that says, “Get Ready for Battle” and cycle repeats. Title screen is shown for 3 seconds.
10. There are 5 levels with 3 rounds for each level. Each level is a new scene. Levels get progressively harder as you move up. At the start of each new level scene, the player selects their home castle and it is instantly surrounded by walls with enough room for the starting number of cannons for that level.

To win the game, the player must survive all rounds and levels.

To increase level hardest, each level could have stronger cannons that do more damage, more castles/enemy ships, rounds in each level could have more battle time, ships could move faster, cannons could be destroyed by enemy fire, etc.



Screenshot: During Bulwark 1475's **combat phase**, your fortress (blue castle) fires cannons at incoming ships or rival's castles. The player must aim, shoot, and hit enemy ships to sink them and/or hit their walls to break them. Plays at a bird's-eye view.



Screenshot: In the **building phase**, Tetris-style wall segments (shown in purple outline, bottom left) are placed to repair breaches and enclose castles. Each fully surrounded castle increases your cannons for the next round. If you fail to surround at least one castle by time's up, the round (or game) is lost.



Screenshot: In the **cannon placement phase**, cannons are placed inside the castle walls for every castle that has fully complete walls.



Screenshot: At the start of each game, the **player has 15 seconds to select their starting home castle out of five available and a fully connected wall instantly surrounds it (no building by the player).** This only happens at the start of each game.



Screenshot: Player sections are separated by a river, wall (can't be destroyed), or canyon.

Story and Setting

Bulwark 1475's narrative is minimal. The player is simply a military commander defending castle keeps from an attacking navy or rival fort. There is no deep plot – it's essentially a “defend the castle” scenario in a medieval-style setting. The title “Bulwark 1475” itself refers to the fortress walls you build. One colorful detail: if you defeat the enemy player, the game shows the loser's commander meeting a grisly fate of walking the plank.

In short, Bulwark 1475's **theme** is a medieval island fortress under siege. Each round takes place on an island (with sand/beach and water edges) where you choose a castle to defend. You build up the Bulwark 1475s around that castle, place cannons, and fend off ships and rival castles. After 3 rounds, you move to a new map/level. There are 5 levels to complete to win the game. The game ends when the player either survives the final stage or runs out of remaining castles.

Visual Style

Bulwark 1475's graphics are simple and blocky, typical of 1990 16-bit arcade hardware. The view is top-down (bird's-eye): green terrain (often checkerboard grass) meets a blue water edge, with small medieval castles and cannons rendered in bright colors. Visual cues include:

- **Castles & Walls:** Each castle is a small sprite (the player's home castle is often tinted blue; others grey or tan) surrounded by wall tiles. Wall segments and gaps are clearly visible on the map.

- **Color Coding:** Each side's castle and cannons are color-coded. On-screen overlays (like crosshairs) show active cannons. The countdown timer and score appear in a stone-brick UI frame along the screen edges.
- **Animation:** Cannonballs arcing across the screen, small ships bobbing in the waves, and explosions when walls or ships are hit. The aesthetic is consistently medieval – look for stone walls, metal cannons, and cartoonish soldiers (grunts) that appear as blocky sprites.

Audio and Music

Bulwark 1475's soundscape emphasizes military action. The game uses **sampled digital effects** for cannon fire and explosions – unlike some chiptune games, Bulwark 1475's cannons and blasts sound like short, digitized samples. A typical round of cannonfire sounds quite realistic and booming. The background **music** consists of pounding war drums and horns, creating a tense, battle-like rhythm. There are also occasional voice samples – for instance, a rumbling knight's voice (the king or commander) gives spoken commands or reactions during play.

Key audio elements include:

- **Digital Explosion/Cannon Samples:** Sharp blasts for each shot and wall hit (no simple beep).
- **War Drums & Melodies:** A martial drumbeat loops during gameplay, heightening the siege atmosphere.
- **Voice Cues:** A king's voice or crowd noises occasionally punctuate events (e.g. after surrounding a castle).

Together, Bulwark 1475's soundtrack reinforces the medieval battle theme without melodic fanfare – it keeps the player focused on defense and artillery rather than a narrative tune.

Ports, Legacy, and Licensing

Bulwark 1475 is often cited as a **tower-defense** type game. Its core idea – repairing fortifications between waves of attackers.

Summary: Bulwark 1475 is a medieval-themed castle-defense game with simple but distinctive graphics and sound. Gameplay revolves around an arcade puzzle loop: you alternately shoot at enemy ships or castles and use block wall pieces that appear as the player's cursor to repair walls. There is no deep story – you are essentially the commander of a fortress under siege – but the game's interface (winning executions, sirens, cheers) gives a tongue-in-cheek heroic flavor. The key points are its **game phases** (cannon placement, battle, repair), its visual style (top-down castle & water), its warlike audio (digital cannons and drums).

